

Tool registry

A tool registry is a centralized catalog that manages the collection of tools (functions, APIs, services) available to an AI agent.

In a recursive term, it knows what tools exist, what they do, and how to use them effectively.

What it contains:

- **Name:** a unique identifier
- **Description:** Natural language explanation of what the tool does (the AI reads this to decide when to use it)
- **Input Schema:** The parameters the tool accepts, with types and constraints
- **Output Schema:** what the tool returns
- **Metadata:** permissions, cost, latency, versioning, etc

But without a registry, an agent would have no structured way to discover or invoke capabilities. The registry is what allows the agent to reason about which tool to use for a given task. It reads the description and schemas to make a decision.